

RICHARD GRAHAM

SENIOR EXECUTIVE ASSISTANT | EXECUTIVE OPERATIONS | EXECUTIVE BUSINESS PARTNER

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EXECUTIVE PROFILE

Executive assistant and executive operations professional with more than a decade of direct support to C-level and senior leaders, including a Genzyme division president and senior vice president, a Merck senior director, a Columbia University anniversary program, a U.S. Senate office, and a private development principal. Manages complex calendars, domestic and international travel, expenses, presentations, meeting and event logistics, executive communications, and confidential records. Trusted as a discerning first point of contact and an autonomous operator who anticipates needs, adapts quickly, and closes open items rather than reporting them.

CORE EXPERTISE

Complex Calendars & Inbox Management | Domestic & International Travel | Expense Reporting, Invoices & Month-End Support | Presentations & Meeting Materials | Visitor & Inquiry Screening | Meeting, Event & Offsite Logistics | Executive Communications | Cross-Team Liaison | Confidential Records | Ad Hoc Projects | Advanced Microsoft Office | Discretion & Sound Judgment

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

INDEPENDENT EXECUTIVE OPERATIONS CONSULTING

Oct 2018-Present

Executive Operations Consultant to Principal (Independent Contractor) | Massachusetts

Private real estate development operation. Multimillion-dollar residential development, property operations, contracts, and financial administration across eastern Massachusetts.

- Serve as executive and operations partner to a private real estate development principal; the engagement with the principal has been continuous since October 2018 and operations are currently conducted through Blackwater Development LLC. Manage inbox, calendar, confidential communications, travel, and daily priorities for the principal.
- Prepare agendas, briefing materials, meeting documents, minutes, and action tracking; triage inquiries across attorneys, brokers, contractors, vendors, tenants, and clients; keep concurrent initiatives moving and give the principal decision-ready information.
- Coordinate municipal Planning Board matters end to end: assemble plans and presentation materials, align the principal and project team, manage participant travel and logistics, and track questions, commitments, and follow-up through completion.
- Administer contracts, leases, invoices, and expenses; maintain QuickBooks records and organized financial, legal, and transaction documentation supporting month-end and reporting needs.
- Conduct due diligence across deeds, chains of title, covenants, affidavits, and historical records to clarify ownership, identify constraints, and surface matters for attorney, title, or other professional review.
- Work autonomously across ad hoc projects and shifting priorities, resolving administrative roadblocks and turning property records and document backlogs into actionable findings.

RICHARD D. GRAHAM, LLC

May 2014-Aug 2018

Sole Member - Real Estate, Solar Energy & Business Operations | Florida

- Directed a sole-member business spanning residential real estate, solar-system sales, educational consulting, and general business administration.
- Managed client and vendor communications, agreements, scheduling, sales follow-through, QuickBooks bookkeeping, expenses, records, and compliance documentation; administered the company's Google Workspace domain, email, calendars, Drive, and collaborative documents through the Admin Console.
- Supported residential sales and leasing activity under brokerage supervision, coordinating documentation, deadlines, clients, lenders, title professionals, and closing participants.

MACY'S

Seasonal appointments, 2010-2014

Sales Ambassador, promoted to Administrative Support Team (AST) Associate | Natick, MA and Orlando, FL

- Supported store HR and management-office operations in Taleo: candidate and new-hire records, offer and onboarding documentation, interview scheduling, and hiring reports.
- Coordinated onboarding, orientation, and training scheduling; served as store HR liaison and coordinated employee and customer participation in United Way, Make-A-Wish, and March of Dimes campaigns.

SELECTED EXECUTIVE OPERATIONS EXPERIENCE

GENZYME CORPORATION THROUGH RANDSTAD Oct 2010-Feb 2011

Senior Administrative Assistant (Contract through Randstad) | Cambridge, MA

- Supported the President of Oncology and Multiple Sclerosis and the Senior Vice President of Strategic Development during the proposed Sanofi acquisition, coordinating executive priorities in a changing environment.

- Prepared executive reports and operational data; supported annual goals, budgets, vendor evaluation, recruiting, personnel assessments, and clinical-affiliation outreach involving Harvard, UMass, and Boston College; mentored incoming administrative staff.

MERCK RESEARCH LABORATORIES THROUGH KELLY SERVICES

Jan 2006-Jan 2007

Executive Assistant (Contract through Kelly Services) | Boston, MA

- Helped bring a new Boston research facility and laboratory into operation while supporting the Senior Director of Molecular Oncology; coordinated workspace and site planning across facilities, IT, AV, security, vendors, scientists, and visitors through startup.
- Managed complex calendars; multi-leg international travel with visa and global time-zone coordination; expenses, site budgets, procurement, and supplies; prepared reports, presentations, correspondence, agendas, minutes, and action items.
- Coordinated recruiting, onboarding, training, team building, meetings, and events so incoming scientific staff arrived to an organized and functioning operation.

COLUMBIA UNIVERSITY - COLUMBIA 250

Sep 2003-Sep 2004

Director of Corporate Sponsorship, Office of Alumni & Development | New York, NY

- Established a corporate-development program for Columbia University's 250th anniversary, creating fundraising plans, multi-tier sponsorship strategies, and an active pipeline of more than 100 corporate prospects.
- Joined recurring senior planning meetings for the year-long program; cultivated and stewarded sponsors and donors; prepared prospect intelligence for board and staff use and coordinated relationships through meetings, calls, events, symposia, and performances.

NEW YORK STATE SENATE - OFFICE OF SENATOR LIZ KRUEGER

May 2002-Mar 2003

Director of Public Affairs & Communications | New York, NY

- Helped establish operations for a newly elected senator's office while directing media, public communications, stakeholder relationships, and district representation.
- Conducted confidential issue research, monitored legislation and policy, and developed public-service initiatives, communications, executive briefings, and draft legislation.

HILLARY RODHAM CLINTON CAMPAIGN, U.S. SENATE OFFICE & HILLPAC

1999-2002

Advanced through five roles: Deputy Finance Director; Constituent Liaison; Finance Associate; Special Projects Manager; Front Desk Coordinator & Executive Screener | New York and Washington, D.C.

- Joined as a campaign volunteer and advanced through five roles in under three years; screened visitors for the campaign manager and press inquiries for the communications director, then helped establish constituent-service processes, correspondence workflows, and databases for the new Senate office.
- Served as Deputy Finance Director on a five-person fundraising and event team, owning donor strategy, cultivation, solicitation, and stewardship, and helping establish the member-based campaign Finance Board.
- Led high-profile fundraising events from donor cultivation through venue, VIP participation, communications, volunteer coordination, security requirements, compliance-sensitive administration, and post-event follow-through, including presidential-level coordination with the Office of the First Lady, the White House, and the U.S. Secret Service.
- Served as the senator's liaison across education, performing arts, children and families, LGBTQ+ matters, labor, science and technology, and Holocaust-survivor issues.

EDUCATION & CREDENTIALS

FLORIDA ATLANTIC UNIVERSITY

Bachelor of Arts in Psychology, cum laude; Minor in Political Science - Liberal Arts Honors Program and Honors Thesis; post-baccalaureate study in Psychobiology.

CUNY GRADUATE CENTER

Graduate Study in Biopsychology / Behavioral Neuroscience & Environmental Psychology - Completed graduate coursework and thesis research.

ADDITIONAL STUDY & CREDENTIAL

Computer Science coursework including C++ programming, University of Central Florida - Florida Real Estate Sales Associate License SL3288477, Current/Active.

TECHNOLOGY

Google Workspace (advanced): Gmail, Calendar, Drive, Docs, Sheets, Slides, Meet, shared resources and Admin Console | Microsoft 365 (advanced): Outlook, Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Teams, SharePoint, OneDrive | Business systems: Concur, Ariba, PeopleSoft, Kronos, Paychex, QuickBooks, Taleo | Collaboration and documents: DocuSign, Adobe Sign, Adobe Acrobat, Box, Dropbox, Notion, Zoom, Apple productivity tools | AI tools: ChatGPT, Claude, Codex and Midpage for research, drafting, summarization, document analysis and workflow design